

Best Practice for Category Design

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Table of Contents

Introduction

1. What do I need to consider before starting designing?.....	4
2. How and when should I use folders?.....	6
3. How should I name cases and categories?.....	7
4. How should I index case & categories?.....	8
5. How many index fields should I have?.....	9
6. When should I use unique fields?.....	10
7. How many other fields should I index?	11
8. When should I use mandatory fields?.....	12
9. When should I use keyword dictionaries.....	13
10. When should I use Primary & Dependent Fields?.....	14
11. When should I use default values?.....	15
12. When should I use regular expressions?.....	16
13. When should I use automatic document linking?.....	17
14. When should I activate full-text searching for a category?.....	18
15. When should I activate water marks?.....	19
16. When should I activate check-in comments?	20
17. Case & Category permissions.....	21
18. What user licenses do I need?	22
19. How many User Licenses do I need?.....	23
20. Storage	24
21. Testing	25

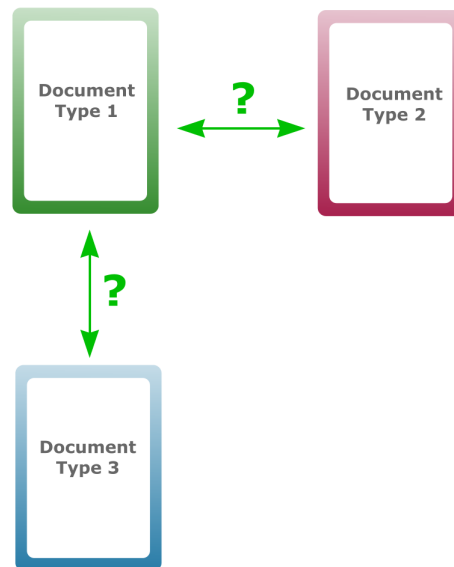
Introduction

Cases and Categories are the primary means of document classification within Therefore[™]. They also define the index data that will be associated with each saved file. Their design is hence very important for a successful Therefore[™] system.

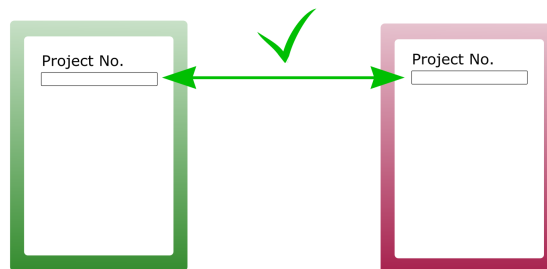
1. What do I need to consider before starting designing?

Perhaps the most important question we need to ask is: what is the relationship between this particular document type and others that we want to save to Therefore™?

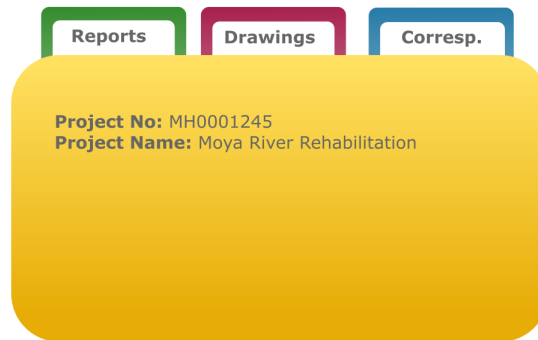
1. Is this document type related to others with common index values?



- For example, project number or invoice number?



2. Should it be part of a binder, together with other related document types? For example, different types of project information?



- If the answer is yes to both of these, then we recommend using Therefore™ Case Management to create a binder containing all related document types. These can then be handled together as one "case" or as separate documents, or document types.
- If the answer is yes to the first and no to the second, then you could create a separate category but link it to related documents using Automatic Links or a Cross Category search template.
- If the answer is no to both, then we recommend creating one individual separate category for the document type.

2. How and when should I use folders?

Folders make it possible to separate and group cases or categories. In larger companies with multiple offices on one Therefore™ system, they can also be used to separate offices. This can make the setting of permissions a lot easier since, by default, child objects inherit from parents. However, care should be taken to not overuse folders and make the system unnecessarily complicated.

3. How should I name cases and categories?

Case and category names should make it intuitive for users to find what they are looking for:

- For cases this would typically be a name that describes the family of document e.g. HR Documents.
- For categories this would typically describe the specific document type e.g. Incoming Invoices.

4. How should I index case & categories?

Here it is important to realize that some index data is dependent on the stored document and some on the organization. For example, the document date cannot change, but the department of the person who saved it could. As a general recommendation:

- Document dependent index data should be stored with the document. E.g. Document type, Document Date, Description etc.
- Organization dependent index data could be referenced from an external table since this may change over time e.g. a job description, department name. E.g. Lastname, Job title, Department etc. However, for cases where you want to lock the organizational index data at the time of saving, dependent index fields can be set to redundant.

In some cases you may want to limit user access based on organizational data e.g. a line manager should only see documents for his CURRENT employees. This can be done using subcategories, BUT, the primary key MUST be an integer.

5. How many index fields should I have?

The main purpose of index fields is to tag case and documents and make them easy to find. Each additional index increases the complexity of both saving and searching.

- As a general principal, index fields should be carefully considered before designing a category and only those really needed should be used.
- A point to note is that index fields do not add to legal compliance. The legal issue is not how you find the documents, but that you can find them. (This may vary for certain countries).
- Category index fields can also be used for comparison or summation purposes. For example, a hit-list of all invoices under 100,000€ could be generated and then the sum of these displayed.

It is recommended that a trial set of index fields be created and tested. Difficulties in searching for documents is often a major reason for reconfiguring a system. It is far better to test and discover this when your system contains 100 documents, and not 100,000.

6. When should I use unique fields?

Fields that contain unique numbers such as serial numbers, order numbers etc. should have their index set to Unique. This not only ensures that a document cannot be created twice but also provides a measure of error-checking and faster searching.

7. How many other fields should I index?

To speed up searching, indexes can be set to Normal on fields that are commonly used for searching. For performance reasons this should be restricted to those fields that are used most often.

8. When should I use mandatory fields?

All fields that are important for searching as well as in hit-list comparisons should be set to mandatory. In addition, mandatory fields can also act as a document validity check. For example, a mandatory index field named Authorized by will help remind users that the document must be authorized and also avoid accidental saving of unauthorized documents.

9. When should I use keyword dictionaries

Keyword lists should be used on fields where there are a number of fixed possible entries. This prevents misspelling and the resultant searching problems.

- Don't use keywords that could overlap or be confused. (e.g. e-mail and mail), rather use e-mail and postal mail.
- Also beware of creating keyword dictionaries that consist of merged lists generated by different users e.g. (e-mail, mail, post, etc.).
- Also avoid abbreviations or specialized terms.
- The default maximum list length is 300. Make sure to change this in the Advanced Therefore™ Server Settings if you use longer lists.
- Unlike external table fields that are updated automatically, any changes to keyword lists must be done manually.

10 When should I use Primary & Dependent Fields?

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It is recommended that index fields containing organizational information should be sourced from database tables. This has two advantages over keyword lists:

- Keyword lists must be manually maintained.
- Any changes to a database table can automatically update the documents index data.

This is a very important consideration as it will affect how documents can be found. For example, a dependent field for the Department Manager: if this is set to redundant, and it changes in the external database, it will not be changed in the document's index fields. This means that the document will always be associated with the Department Manager at the time the document was saved.

11 When should I use default values?

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Where possible, default values should be use to speed up indexing (e.g. <File Title> will automatically get the name of the file being saved). Default values also act as a hint for the data required. For example, the use of <DATE> (meaning today's date) is recommended for an index field that contains a Scanned on or Pages added on value.

12 When should I use regular expressions?

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Regular expressions can be used on text fields to make sure that a user keys in the data according to a certain format e.g. email address or case number. These should be used on any critical text field that has a standard format and that needs to be entered manually. This provides an important check, especially on repetitive input where it is easy to make a small mistake that will later make finding the document very difficult.

13 When should I use automatic document linking?

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This is useful where users need to find related documents when searching. Any documents that share a common index type and value can be linked. The advantage over cross category searching is that the user just has to use a standard search for one document and will automatically find all the linked documents, as well.

14 When should I activate full-text searching for a category?

Full-text searching is most helpful for unstructured data where the contents of the document is more important than the type of document. It is helpful for categories that do not have any easily remembered index data. For example, a user may have a category to save all marketing material. It is then sometimes easier to find a document based on the content rather than on title.

By default it is set to active for each category, but it can be deactivated on categories that do not require it in order to use resources more efficiently.

15 When should I activate water marks?

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Water marks provide an additional safeguard for certain documents when they are printed. For example, a certain category may have documents only for internal use. To stop a user printing and then publishing them externally, you could add a water mark "Internal use only".

Watermarks can be printed onto many common file types that are displayed by the Therefore Multi-format Viewer (see User Manual for more details).

16 When should I activate check-in comments?

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Check-in comments are recommend for all categories where it is important to quickly know what has changed in a document.

17 Case & Category permissions

Careful consideration should be given to permissions. Users should only be given the permissions that they absolutely require.

During installation, an administrator and user group must be defined. These two groups are then added by default to Therefore™.

By default permissions in Therefore™ are inherited from parent objects starting from the top Therefore™ Object.

By default the administrator group has all permissions on the object. The user group has Read/Write permissions.

This is then by default carried down to the Category object, then Folders below that, then categories etc.

If permissions on a certain group of categories should be different from the category object then a folder can be created and the inheritance broken. This can also be done on any other category object lower down in the hierarchy.

Another way of handling this would be to add a user or group and given them different permissions. Also be aware that using "Deny" will override "Allow". For example if a permission for a group is set to "Deny", but an individual user in that group has "Allow" then the user will have No access.

Therefore™ provides an extensive list of permissions that can be used to control folders, categories and cases. A full list can be accessed [here](#).

18 What user licenses do I need?

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Therefore™ user licenses are required for the use of the Therefore™ client applications. Users can be from Active Directory®, LDAP/SAMBA, a local user group or Therefore™ internal users.

When a user opens a Therefore™ application, this user needs to have a Named, Concurrent or Read-only license assigned; and, this user cannot have an active session on more than one device simultaneously.

- A session is active until a user disconnects (for web/mobile) or closes the application (for installed clients); or, until the session is not used for about 60 minutes.
- If a user tries to log on to a session on another device simultaneously, the user will be presented with a dialog asking if they would like to sign off the first session. One exception is for named users using Therefore™ MFP Scan or integration with eCopy® ShareScan. In these two cases simultaneous use is allowed on one Named User license.

Named User Licenses

Named user licenses can be assigned to users, otherwise free licenses will be automatically assigned to the first user that requires one. In systems with only Named users (e.g. Therefore™ Workgroup) these could be left unassigned. Any free licenses will automatically be given to the first new user to log onto the system and will be unassigned again after an inactive period of about 100hrs (4 days). However in systems that use both named and concurrent licenses, to avoid Named licenses being assigned to the wrong users, these should be assigned.

Concurrent User Licenses

A Concurrent User license is not assigned to a specific user and can be used on any workstation, by any user with the required permissions in Therefore™.

Read-only User Licenses

Therefore™ Read-only User licenses limit a user's permissions on documents (see Administrator manual for more info). Read-only User licenses will only be granted to users that have been assigned to the Read-only pool. The number of available read-only licenses determines how many users from the pool can simultaneously use the licenses.

19 How many User Licenses do I need?

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You can use the following "rules of thumb" to help deciding how many user licenses a customer needs. But, this will probably vary a lot depending on customer preferences and behavior.

Named User Licenses

1 Named user license is needed for each user that needs to view and edit documents all the time, without waiting.

Concurrent User Licenses

Concurrent User licenses can be used for users that need to view and edit documents sometimes. As a very rough starting guide you could take the number of users and divide by 3. But, this would be very dependent on user behavior.

Read-only User Licenses

Read-only User can be used for users that need to only view documents. As a very rough starting guide you could take the number of users and divide by 3. But, this would be very dependent on user behavior.

20 Storage

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Primary & backup storage configuration

Documents saved to Therefore™ are initially saved to the Buffer directory "C:\Program Files\Therefore\Buffer". This however is just for temporary storage. It is very important that a storage method for primary, and ideally also backup (disaster recovery), already be decided on in the planning process. Without this, saved documents are at risk of being lost in the event of a hardware failure, theft or natural disaster.

Personal Edition users may simply rely on regular back-ups from their own PC. However, be aware that the computer's Windows® registry must also be backed-up if the Therefore™ system is to be recreated after a disk crash.

21 Testing

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Testing your configuration

It is recommended that a trial set of categories and index fields be created and tested. Difficulties in searching for documents is often a major reason for reconfiguring a system. It is far better to test and discover this when your system contains 100 documents, and not 100,000.